

Prompt

You are a senior product UI refactor engineer and desktop-app visual systems specialist.

Your task is NOT to rebuild the app from scratch.

Your task is to perform a focused, high-discipline visual refactor of the existing note-taking app so the look and feel matches the provided screenshot references much more closely.

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PRIMARY OBJECTIVE

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Refactor the existing app's visual system, component styling, spacing, control language, and UI atmosphere so it feels much closer to:

- ChatGPT desktop / Mac app
- Codex Mac app
- the screenshot references I provided in this conversation
- the rounded floating control surfaces shown in the screenshots
- the premium chip/button language shown in the screenshots
- the clean light-mode workspace feeling shown in the screenshots

Do NOT redesign the product into something else.

Do NOT rewrite the entire architecture.

Do NOT discard the existing component structure unless absolutely necessary.

This is a LOOK AND FEEL REFACTOR.

Not a full product rewrite.

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VISUAL SOURCE OF TRUTH

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Use the screenshot references I provided as direct visual guidance.

These references are especially important for:

1. FLOATING COMMAND BAR

- rounded pill-shaped toolbar
- soft border
- minimal icon row
- clean spacing
- centered icons
- low-noise presentation

- calm premium feel

2. CHIP / PILL BUTTONS

- “Add page icon”
- “Add page cover”
- “Add”
- “Product Interpretation”
- “Information Architecture”

These show the exact kind of rounded chip/button treatment I want.

3. LARGE ROUNDED INPUT / COMPOSER SURFACE

- the large rounded prompt box shown in the screenshot
- soft border
- spacious interior
- light premium surface
- circular action buttons inside the composer

4. CHATGPT-LIKE SIDEBAR / PROJECTS RAIL

- clean left rail
- soft separators
- quiet selected states
- rounded row treatments
- premium spacing
- strong but calm hierarchy
- desktop-app feel, not dashboard feel

5. ACTION HISTORY / STATUS CARD SURFACES

- rounded white cards
- subtle borders
- sectioned content
- low-noise hierarchy
- clean success/check states
- light, premium utility card feel

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REFRACTOR GOAL

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The existing app should be transformed from:

- “good React prototype”

into:

- “premium Mac-style note-taking workspace”

It must feel:

- rounded
- soft
- premium
- minimal
- calm
- spacious
- precise
- desktop-native
- very intentionally designed

It must NOT feel:

- generic
- boxy
- too webby
- too dashboard-like
- too developer-tool-ish
- too much like raw Tailwind defaults
- too much like default Lucide dropped into buttons
- too sharp or squared

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STRICT SCOPE
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This pass is primarily about:

- visual system
- component styling
- spacing
- radii
- shadows
- borders
- icon presentation
- toolbar presentation
- chip/button styling
- sidebar styling
- page header styling
- card styling
- empty states
- input/composer styling
- light-mode quality
- dark-mode parity if already present

Do NOT make unnecessary logic rewrites.
Do NOT break existing functionality.

Do NOT remove existing product features unless a visual wrapper replacement requires it.
Do NOT “simplify away” features just because the refactor is hard.

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NON-NEGOTIABLE DESIGN DIRECTION

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The final UI must feel much closer to the screenshot references.

That means:

- more rounded major surfaces
- more rounded chip buttons
- more rounded floating toolbars
- softer borders
- more elegant light surfaces
- more generous breathing room
- cleaner icon centering
- more deliberate control sizing
- more premium spacing rhythm
- less utility-strip energy
- less generic toolbar energy
- less admin-dashboard energy

The app should feel like a modern Mac app.
Not a themed website.

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VISUAL PROBLEMS TO FIX

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You must specifically identify and fix areas where the current UI still feels:

- too square
- too flat
- too dense in the wrong places
- too generic
- too Lucide-default
- too much like a standard toolbar
- too much like a generic sidebar
- too much like a standard form app
- not rounded enough
- not premium enough in light mode
- not close enough to the screenshot references

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DESIGN SYSTEM CHANGES REQUIRED

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Refactor the design system tokens and component primitives to better match the screenshot language.

You must revisit:

1. RADIUS SCALE

Current radii are likely too conservative.
Push the system more rounded.

Target feel:

- small controls: softly rounded
- chips/buttons: noticeably rounded
- floating bars: strongly rounded
- dialogs/cards/composer surfaces: generously rounded
- sidebar selected rows: softly rounded

The UI should feel rounded everywhere in a restrained premium way.

2. BORDER TREATMENT

Borders should be:

- subtle
- light
- elegant
- thin
- low-noise
- soft gray in light mode

Avoid harsh outlines.

3. SHADOW TREATMENT

Shadows should be:

- soft
- minimal
- premium
- supportive, not dramatic

4. SURFACE HIERARCHY

Light mode should use:

- soft white

- light warm-gray or neutral-gray layering
- subtle tonal separation
- very clean page surfaces

5. SPACING RHYTHM

Spacing should feel:

- spacious
- calm
- controlled
- premium
- consistent

6. ICON SYSTEM PRESENTATION

Icons must feel:

- centered
- slightly more refined than default
- consistent in stroke visual weight
- properly sized relative to their containers
- visually balanced inside rounded controls

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COMPONENTS THAT MOST NEED VISUAL REWORK

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Prioritize visual refactoring of:

- floating command bar
- fixed/visible command toolbar
- page header
- add page icon / add page cover / add controls
- sidebar shell
- sidebar rows
- sidebar footer/header
- search field
- icon buttons
- chip buttons
- top-level action rows
- input/composer surfaces
- import dialog
- cards/status panels
- settings panel
- modal/dialog shells
- empty states

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BUTTON / CHIP / CONTROL REQUIREMENTS

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I want the buttons and chips to feel much closer to the screenshot references.

That means:

- rounded pill or rounded-rect treatment
- softer outlines
- larger internal horizontal padding
- more elegant label typography
- clean icon + text alignment
- more premium whitespace
- very controlled height
- no cheap “default button” feeling

Button types should visually support:

- chip buttons
- icon-only circular or rounded-square controls
- floating action controls
- toolbar controls
- subtle secondary buttons
- quiet ghost buttons

Use the screenshot references as the benchmark.

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COMMAND BAR REQUIREMENTS

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The command bar is one of the most important visual areas.

It must be transformed into something much closer to the screenshot references:

- floating
- rounded pill shape
- soft border
- elegant horizontal rhythm
- slightly larger internal padding
- visually separated groups
- soft separators
- calm icon spacing
- premium light surface

It should NOT look like:

- a standard document toolbar
- a dense formatting ribbon
- a thin strip docked to the top
- a generic flex row with icons

It should feel like:

- a premium floating note-building control surface

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SIDEBAR REQUIREMENTS

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The sidebar should be refactored to feel closer to ChatGPT desktop / projects UI.

That means:

- calmer visual hierarchy
- more premium row spacing
- better grouping
- more rounded selected states
- cleaner project/page row treatment
- quieter separators
- a more native desktop feel

The sidebar should NOT feel like:

- a file explorer
- a dashboard nav
- a plain list with borders

It should feel like:

- a premium workspace rail

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PAGE HEADER REQUIREMENTS

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The page header should be redesigned to visually resemble the screenshot references more closely.

Include the visual language of:

- chip controls
- add page icon
- add page cover
- add menu
- spacious title region

- premium top spacing
- soft metadata handling
- a cleaner editorial content start

The header should feel:

- open
- premium
- spacious
- intentional
- calm

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LIGHT MODE QUALITY BAR

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The light theme must be excellent.

It should feel:

- refined
- editorial
- soft white
- premium
- minimal
- elegant
- not sterile
- not harsh
- not default

This is very important.

The screenshots show a high-quality light mode.

Match that atmosphere.

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ICONOGRAPHY REQUIREMENT

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Even if using Lucide or a similar library, the final icon presentation must not feel like untouched defaults.

You must refine:

- size
- stroke presence
- spacing
- visual centering

- pairing with labels
- container fit

Icons should feel:

- rounded
- elegant
- premium
- minimal
- calm
- consistent

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IMPLEMENTATION STRATEGY

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Do this as a visual refactor pass, not as a random rewrite.

You must work in this order:

STEP 1 — VISUAL AUDIT

Audit the current UI against the screenshot references and identify:

- what already works
- what feels off
- what feels too generic
- what feels too square
- what components most need restyling

STEP 2 — VISUAL MAPPING

Map current components to target screenshot behaviors:

- which component becomes the floating toolbar reference
- which components become chip controls
- which component becomes the composer-like surface language
- which components need sidebar refactor
- which buttons need size/radius/padding changes

STEP 3 — TOKEN / PRIMITIVE REFACTOR

Refactor:

- radius tokens
- border tokens
- spacing tokens
- shadow tokens
- control heights
- icon sizing rules
- button primitives

- chip primitives
- card primitives
- toolbar primitives

STEP 4 — COMPONENT RESTYLING

Apply the new visual system to the actual components.

STEP 5 — POLISH PASS

Do a final consistency pass across:

- toolbar
- chips
- sidebar
- header
- cards
- dialogs
- settings
- import UI
- spacing
- icons
- light mode

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DO NOT DO THESE THINGS

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Do NOT:

- rewrite all business logic unnecessarily
- remove working features because styling is hard
- introduce a brand new design language
- make it more squared
- make it more dashboard-like
- use generic SaaS cards everywhere
- output vague suggestions without actually applying them
- ignore the screenshot references
- keep default-looking Lucide placements
- treat this as a small CSS tweak

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DELIVERABLE REQUIREMENTS

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When implementing, you must:

- list the files you changed
- explain why each change was made

- explain how each change maps back to the screenshot references
- call out anything that still does not match yet
- be honest if any component still needs another pass

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SUCCESS CRITERIA

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This refactor is successful only if:

- the app looks meaningfully closer to my screenshots
- the floating toolbar feels premium and rounded
- the buttons/chips feel like the screenshot references
- the sidebar feels more like ChatGPT desktop
- the page header feels more polished and spacious
- the light mode feels premium
- the app no longer feels like a generic React editor
- the UI feels much more like a real Mac app

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STRICT PHASED EXECUTION / ANTI-HALLUCINATION RULES

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You must execute this visual refactor in phases.

Do NOT skip ahead.

Do NOT rewrite unrelated logic.

Do NOT claim visual parity unless the affected components were actually updated.

Do NOT hallucinate completed styling, tokens, components, screenshots, or files.

Do NOT say something matches the screenshots unless you explicitly explain how it matches them.

Before each phase:

- restate the exact scope of the phase
- list what is in scope
- list what is out of scope
- list which files you will inspect or modify
- list assumptions
- list risks

After each phase:

1. say exactly what was completed
2. say what was not completed
3. list the files changed
4. list what still does not match the screenshots

5. say what the next phase will address

If a component is only partially improved, say it is partial.
Do not present partial work as final parity.

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REQUIRED VISUAL REFACTOR PHASES

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PHASE 1 — VISUAL AUDIT ONLY

Only do:

- audit the current UI against the screenshot references
- identify what feels too generic
- identify what feels too square
- identify what feels too web-like
- identify which components most need refactoring

Do NOT write code in this phase.

PHASE 2 — VISUAL MAPPING ONLY

Only do:

- map current components to screenshot-inspired target behavior
- define which existing components should become:
 - floating command bar
 - chip controls
 - page header chip row
 - sidebar rail
 - composer-like surface
 - rounded card/status surfaces

Do NOT write final styling code in this phase.

PHASE 3 — TOKEN / PRIMITIVE REFACTOR

Only do:

- radius token refactor
- border token refactor
- spacing token refactor
- shadow token refactor
- button primitive refactor
- chip primitive refactor
- toolbar primitive refactor
- card primitive refactor

Do NOT restyle the full product yet.

PHASE 4 — COMPONENT RESTYLING

Only do:

- floating toolbar
- chip/button controls
- page header
- sidebar
- cards/status panels
- search/input/composer surfaces
- import dialog surfaces

Do NOT do broad unrelated logic rewrites.

PHASE 5 — CONSISTENCY / POLISH PASS

Only do:

- visual consistency pass
- icon alignment pass
- spacing cleanup
- light mode refinement
- screenshot-match cleanup
- responsive polish for affected components

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NON-NEGOTIABLE HONESTY RULE

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If the UI still does not fully match the screenshots after a phase, say so clearly.
Do not claim “done” or “matched” unless the visual result is genuinely close.

Screenshot References

Gemini 3.1 Pro Preview • Canceled

 Action history

 Edited 1 file

components/editor/BlockEditor.tsx



 Built

 The task was canceled.

 Restored from previous checkpoint

( Working

hooks/useBlocks.ts	
components/editor/BlockEditor.tsx	
components/editor/BlockNode.tsx	
components/editor/PageSurface.tsx	
components/editor/SlashCommandMenu.tsx	
store/useUIStore.ts	
components/editor/FloatingToolbar.tsx	



Product Interpretation

Information Architecture

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Add page icon

Add page cover

Add



Make changes, add new features, ask for anything

